

Designing for the ADHD Brain

How the Gentle Planner transforms budgeting and habit tracking from a source of guilt into a space of grace.

Gentle Approach

Neuroinclusive Design

Grace over Guilt

WELCOME, NAME - GENTLE PLANNING

ADHD-Friendly Budget & Habit Planner

A soft place to keep the little things visible. Add one entry at a time - perfect planning still counts.

• They steps are real steps

INCOME	EXPENSES	SAVINGS	LITTLE STEPS
\$0.00	\$0.00	0 / 0	0

Quick brain-dump
No specific order is perfect.

What are you adding?
Expense

Name it simply

Amount

Category

Date
06/25/2024

A note, if helpful

+ Add to my planner

YOUR GENTLE OVERVIEW

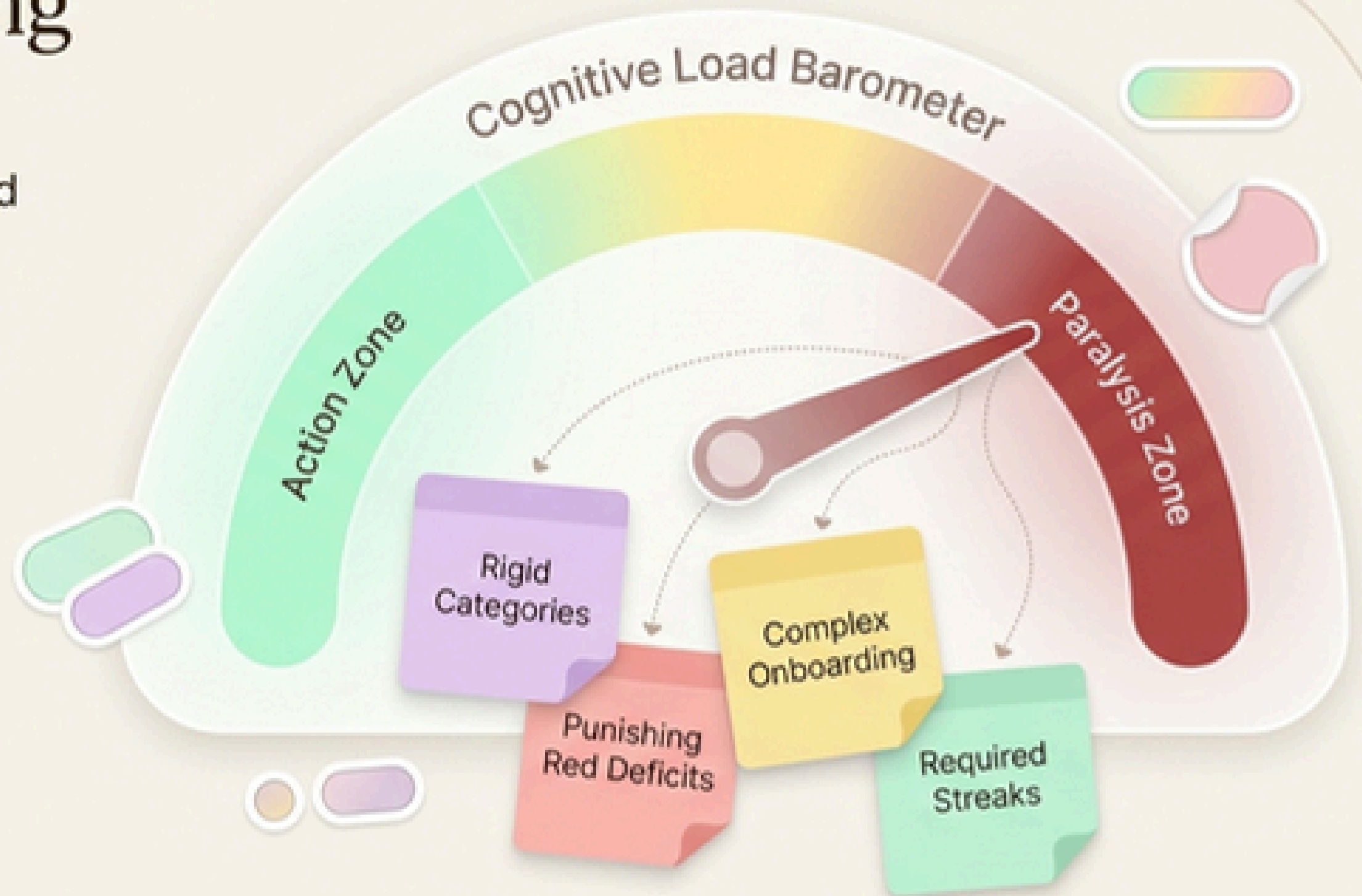
Today's planner

• One thing at a time

Your page is ready when you are.
Start with one expense, one list of habits, or one habit you want to remember. That is enough.

The friction of traditional tracking

Traditional spreadsheets demand perfection. For the ADHD brain, rigid categorization and punitive visual cues lead to immediate executive dysfunction and task paralysis. They measure failure, not progress.



Shifting from Accountability to Accessibility

The Old Way

-  Punitive tracking
-  Complex categorization
-  Guilt-driven motivation
-  Demands daily streaks
-  High cognitive load

Imperfect
planning
still counts.

The Gentle Way

-  Forgiving tracking
-  Brain-dump entry
-  Grace-driven motivation
-  Celebrates little wins
-  Low cognitive load

The architecture of a neuroinclusive planner

A soft place to keep the little things visible. Let's break down the psychological safety engineered into this workspace.

1

INCOME
\$0.00

SPENDING
\$0.00

HABITS DONE
0/0

LITTLE WINS
0

2

Quick brain-dump
No need to make it perfect.

What are you adding?
Expense

Name it simply

Amount
Category

Date
08/25/2026

A note, if helpful

+ Add to my planner

3

YOUR GENTLE OVERVIEW
Today's planner
One thing at a time

♥

Your page is ready when you are.
Start with one expense, one bit of income, or one habit you want to remember. That is enough.

Eliminating input friction

Quick brain-dump
No need to make it perfect.

What are you adding?

Expense ✓

Name it simply

Amount Category

Date

08/25/2026

A note, if helpful

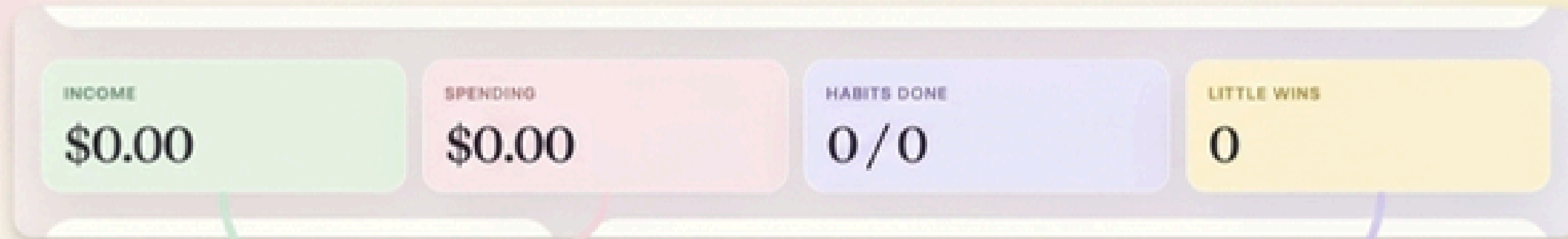
+ Add to my planner

Removes the cognitive roadblock of over-categorizing and over-thinking.

Empathetic microcopy that directly combats perfectionism-induced paralysis.

Single entry focus. Eliminates the dread of bulk-logging associated with massive spreadsheets.

Metrics that don't yell at you



Pastel color-coding prevents the anxiety of harsh 'alert' colors. No stark reds or severe blacks used to indicate financial reality.

Gamifies positive reinforcement. Crucial for dopamine-deficient brains that need immediate reward loops to build momentum.

The power of the empty state

Acts as an immediate grounding technique *technique* for wandering attention and task overwhelm.

One thing at a time

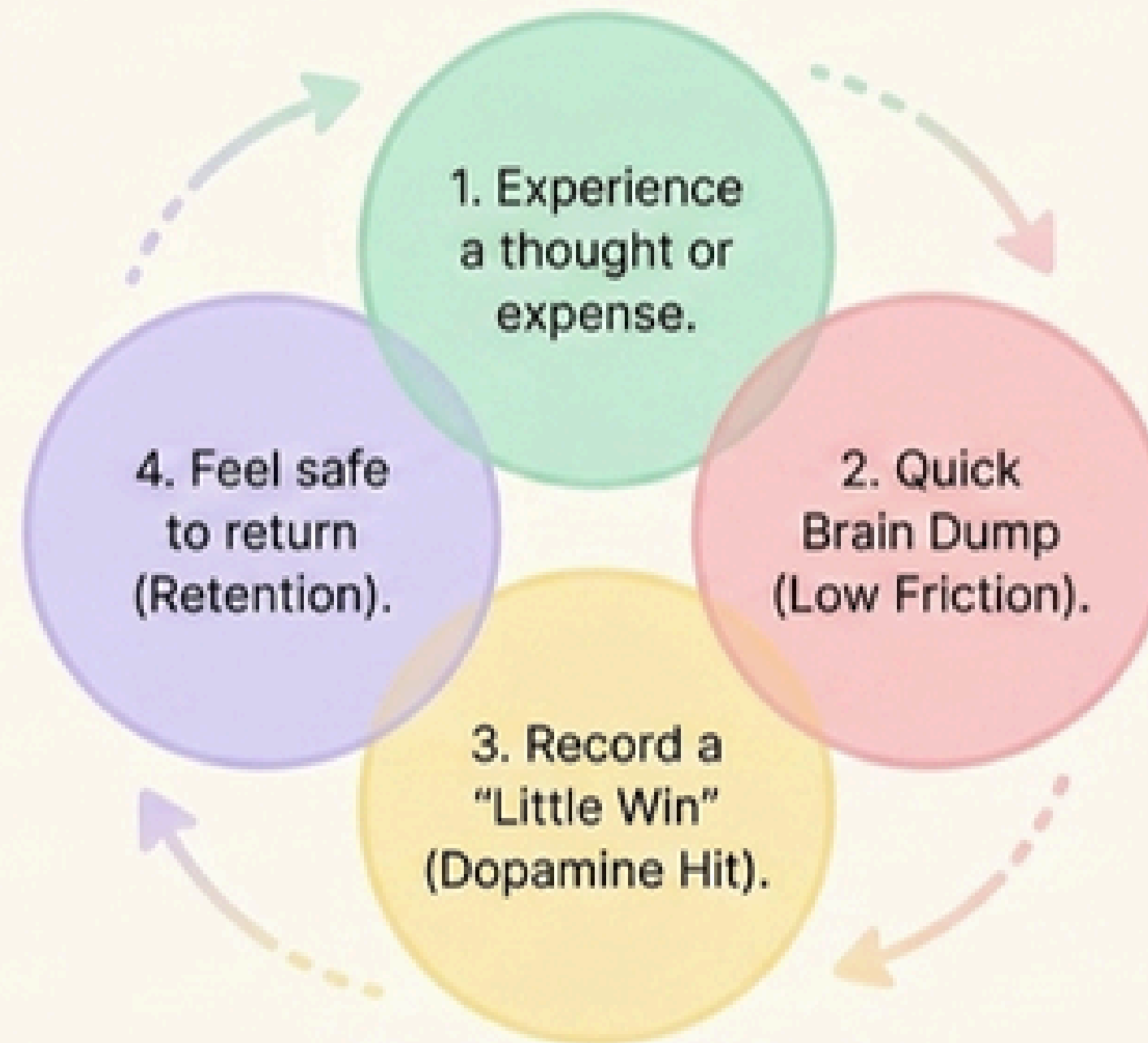


Your page is ready when you are.

Start with one expense, one bit of income, or one habit you want to remember. That is enough.

An empty screen is usually intimidating. Here, the empty state is used for active emotional regulation and validation.

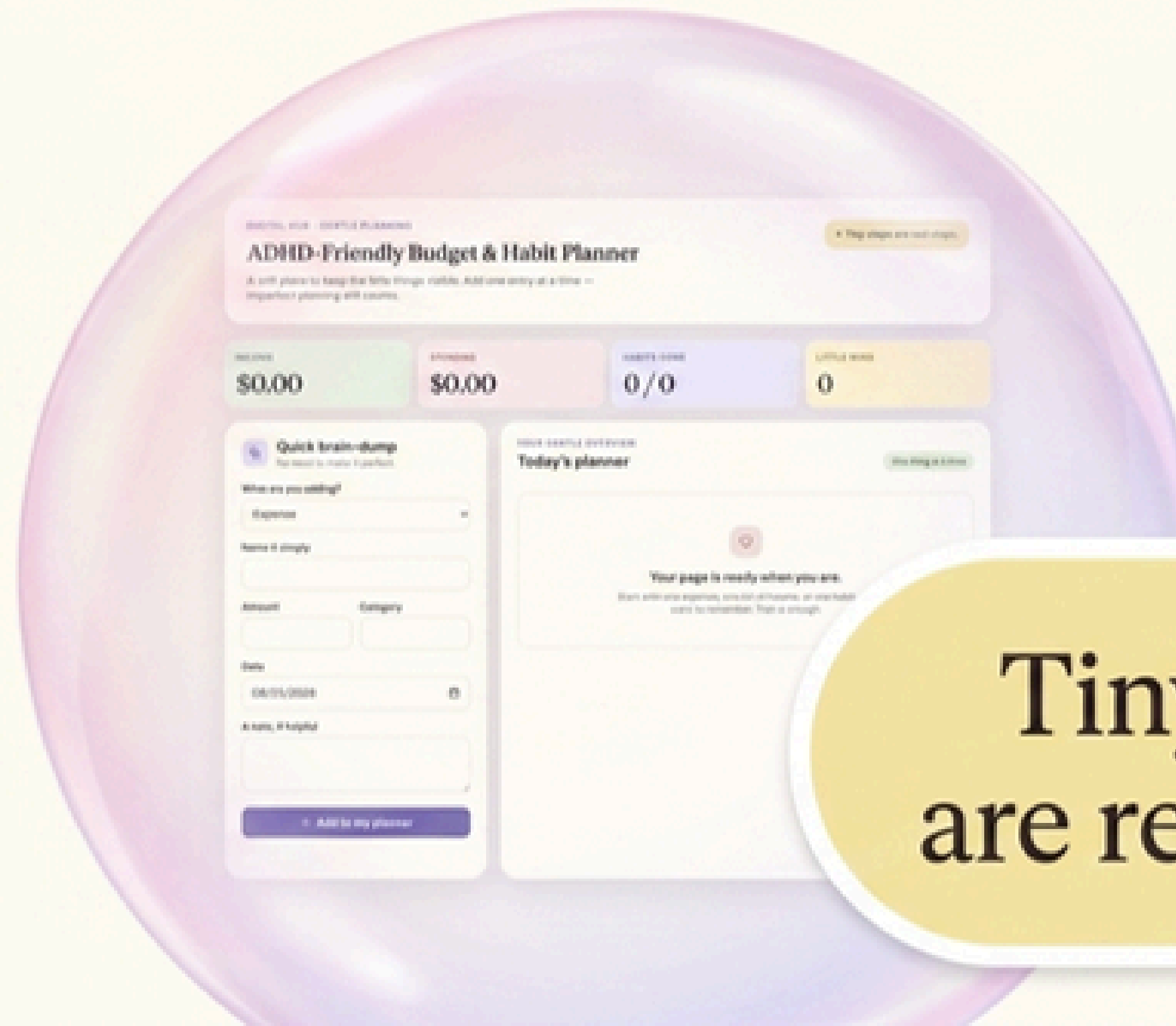
The gentle workflow



By lowering the barrier to entry, imperfect planning builds consistency where rigid systems build avoidance.

A holistic environment for neurodivergent minds

It's not just a budget planner; it's an environment engineered from the ground up to reduce cognitive fatigue and celebrate micro-progress.



Tiny steps
are real steps.

Start your gentle planning journey today.

Available via Canva.

+ Add to my planner

lovelle-fashions-accessories.my.canva.site/adhd-friendly-budget-habits-planner